

Chris Rime's AFRICAN BLUES

LIVE



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A concert by Chris Rime and his African Blues Band is a unique experience where the Blues reveals its history and its innermost essence. It's a meeting of two continents through traditional standards that everyone knows. It's an evening of sharing and history, a tribute and journey to the African origins of the Blues.

The Band

Beyond their roots in American culture, Blues, Gospel, and Jazz share a common origin: Africa. It is to these sun-drenched lands that the project initiated by Chris Rime takes us. The guitarist offers us live performances of his African versions, already immortalized on his album *Blues Black Home*, of American standards we all know. A return to the true sources of the Blues! To complete the journey, Chris Rime has surrounded himself with Congolese-born singer Isaac L. Vita, who performs some of the songs in Mbololo (Cameroonian dialect) and Ingala (Congolese dialect), as well as Cameroonian bassist Bobby Jocky (Bashung, Higelin,...) and Marvel Cedric on Drums (Manou Gallo) from Cameroon and the Caribbean percussionist Dominique Tauliaut (Kassav...). Sometimes kora player Djeli Moussa Diawara (Bob Brozman, Carlos Santana...) also joins this top-flight ensemble.

Chris Rime has performed or recorded with: Marcus Miller, Paco Sery, Nguyen Lê, Linley Marthe, Raul Paz, Mario Canonge, Nicole Croisille, Stéphane Belmondo, Laurent de Wilde, Etienne Mbappé, Djeli Moussa Diawara...

Live! VIDEO



BIO

Chris Rime



Music quickly became an essential part of Chris Rime's life. To accompany his siblings, he started playing drums at age 10, then discovered the guitar, which he would never put down. He gave his first concerts while still in middle school. At 16, he formed a duo with Nguyen Lê and performed regularly in Parisian clubs. Barely an adult, he crossed the Atlantic to enroll at the legendary Berklee College of Music.

Back in France, he took on numerous projects, both as a sideman and as a leader in Jazz and Fusion with his group Soap Op. He performed with John Cage at the Villa Medici and also appeared on the stages of the La Défense Jazz Competition, the Underwater Image Music Competition, and later, the "A Sound for the Year 2000" competition in Val de Marne.

In 1995, Chris released his first album, "RIME," recorded with Mokhtar Samba and Michel Alibo. This album, then in rotation on national radio stations, was acclaimed by the music press. Production companies regularly sought him out for his talents as a composer and producer.

Chris went on to release five albums under his own name, including a live album, as well as several concert series. His list of guest artists is prestigious: Paco Sery, Linley Marthe, Laurent De Wilde, Etienne Mbappé, Stéphane Belmondo, Roger Biwandu, Marcus Miller, Mario Canonge...

Beyond jazz, he also participates in world music, gospel, and pop projects alongside Georges Seba, Djeli Moussa Diawara, and his partner Audren and daughter Jemily Rime.

In 2021, his sixth album, *At The Bar With Mr Punk*, was released, once again featuring talented guests: Hadrien Feraud, Federico Malaman, Dominique Di Piazza, and Stéphane Castry. On this album, honed in concert with Tilo Bertholo and Rody Cereyon, Chris, the virtuoso, explores new avenues and breaks the mold of instrumental music by blending electro, rock, and funk with jazz fusion.

Since 1997, Chris has composed and produced music for television (documentaries on Arte and France Télévisions), film (*Frankie* by F. Berthaud starring Diane Kruger), and AAA video games. He is also an educator, giving masterclasses and publishing several best-selling books on guitar and computer music.

Framus Guitars has supported Chris Rime since 2015.

WWW.CHRISTOPHERIME.COM

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PRESS

Batteur Magazine – Chris Rime • BLUES BLACK HOME •

He released "Blues Black Home" as his third album, after "RIME" and "Heavy Loud Funk Menuet." Chris Rime has a very genuine blues-funk manner of expression! The CD has an exquisite homogeneity due to the smooth blending of his original songs and covers. Although the record is unquestionably the product of a guitarist, two particular guest musicians Pierre-Olivier Govin and Stéphane Belmondo stand out. Rime also gives his rhythm section a lot of thought. Although Mokhtar Samba and Paco Sery were featured on earlier albums, Etienne M'Bappé and Roger Biwandu, the band's mainstays, are the ones who set the groove on this one! The drummer's playing is subtle but very powerful. A strong record that holds up!

Guitarist – Chris Rime • BLUES BLACK HOME •

Funk or Blues? Blues or Funk? Between the two, Rime's heart is undoubtedly divided. With the perfect balance of flavor and contagious energy, it throws them off with ease. It's fantastic that Rime doesn't stick to just one style since it allows us to enjoy a rich album with warm, precise sounds that are expertly condensed into a variety of grooves. Stéphane Belmondo's Miles Davis-esque trumpet ("Birdy Niam Miam") and Etienne Mbappé's turbocharged bass ("Wild Girl," "Last Fair Deal"), which flawlessly pushes his leader's guitar, are both delightfully rediscoverable throughout the album. The addition of Djeli Moussa Diawara's kora to Chris Rime's guitar delicately evokes the African origins of jazz ("What a Wonderful World") and the blues ("Walk On"). Chris Rime creates an album where the guitar shines without artifice (it rhymes!) by steering clear of the traps of ostentatious, gaudy choruses.

Guitarist Acoustic – Chris RIME • BLUES BLACK HOME • (Night & Day)

Chris Rime, a devotee of Big Bill Broonzy and Robert Johnson, returns to his initial passion, the blues of the southern United States and Africa, after focusing his first two albums on jazz fusion. Thanks to the efforts of Moussa Diawara (kora) and Stéphane Belmondo, the effects are no longer present; the blues is clean and pure, raw but sensitive. Through standards that honor such notable figures as Louis Armstrong and Ray Charles, Chris also demonstrates his arranging prowess. Not to be overlooked are the contributions of Georges Seba, Claude Terranova, Roger Biwandu, Pierre Olivier Govin, bassist Etienne M'Bappé, and everyone else who worked on the project. Blues Black Home received cinematic acclaim, being chosen for the soundtrack of the film "Frankie" by F. Berthaud, starring Diane Kruger and Carole Laure.

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